



Christian Hospital Bissamcuttack

Introduction

In 1954, Dr. Elizabeth Madsen, a compassionate general practitioner from Denmark, hearing about the huge health needs in this region, set foot in Bissamcuttack with a profound mission: to bring healthcare within reach of the most marginalized and disadvantaged. At 41 years of age, driven by a fervent desire to make a difference, she established a modest clinic on the veranda of the local Lutheran church. She trained local people to take on the various tasks needed in a small hospital. She led the fledgling institution for the first 22 years with the support of Danish Missionary society following which the support was withdrawn and Christian Hospital, became a self-supporting institution under the guidance of Dr. and Mrs. Henry. Over time, this seed that she planted, nurtured by God's continuous blessing has flourished into the Christian Hospital Bissamcuttack we are privileged to witness today.

In 1966, the Christian Hospital Bissamcuttack Society was formally registered under the Societies Registration Act of 1860. Before we proceed further, here are the objectives of the society outlined in the memorandum of association.

The objectives of the society are:

1. To administer the Christian Hospital and all its activities at Bissamcuttack and elsewhere specifically for the purpose of treatment of persons suffering from illness or of persons otherwise requiring medical attention. Without prejudice to the generality of the above purpose, to provide, as an expression of the love of God as shown in Jesus Christ, medical service to the needy, irrespective of caste, creed, community or gender. It shall be administered solely as a philanthropic institution and not for purpose of profit.
2. To train personnel necessary for health care work, especially from the Christian community, through the establishment of a School of Nursing and other ancillary training, an English Medium School, an Oriya Medium School and other similar educational projects as needed.
3. To provide facilities for research in medical work and health work particularly relating to rural areas.
4. To cooperate with the Government and other agencies in providing medical relief.
5. To solicit, receive and disburse funds to meet the objectives stated above.
6. To do such lawful things as are incidental and conducive to the attainment of the above objects.



Bissamcuttack is a small town of about 8,000–9,000 people in Rayagada district, near the junction of Rayagada, Kondhamal, and Kalahandi districts of Odisha state. Bissamcuttack Block has a population of around 90,000, with approximately 64% Scheduled Tribes and 17% Scheduled Castes (Census 2011).

While the block recorded a negative growth rate of about 8% between 1981–1991, Rayagada district overall showed positive growth of about 15.7% from 2001–2011. The district's sex ratio in 2011 was 1,051 females per 1,000 males.

In this context, **Christian Hospital, Bissamcuttack**, a 72-year-old, 200-bedded, faith-based community hospital, serves the vulnerable and needy population of southern and western Odisha through:

- Health Care – that is both high quality and low cost
- Training in Health – with Situational Excellence and Social Relevance
- Education for Children – of the highest standards and the lowest costs possible

CHRISTIAN HOSPITAL, BISSAMCUTTACK - UNITS

<u>HEALTH CARE</u>	<u>TRAINING</u>	<u>EDUCATION</u>
HOSPITAL-1954	COLLEGE OF NURSING (CON)	NEW LIFE ENGLISH MEDIUM SCHOOL-1986
200 bed Multidisciplinary-Medicine, Surgery, Obstetrics, Paediatrics, Ophthalmology <u>Avg patients/day</u> 251 OP, 40.7 IP, 12.8 Surgeries, 7.8 Deliveries Bed occupancy -105%	ANM's since 1978 GNM's since 1996 BSc since 2018	580 children ICSE Syllabus 1-10 TH grades
MITRA-COMMUNITY HEALTH OUTREACH	MITRA TRAINING AND RESOURCE UNIT	MITRA RESIDENTIAL SCHOOL, KACHAPAJU - 1998
Serving 13, 500 people in 54 predominantly tribal villages since 1978	Training, consultancy and publications in community health	Education upholding the tribal heritage 1-5 grades 155 children from 16 hill- tribe villages

At our hospital, we are dedicated to delivering healthcare services that directly meet the needs of our community. With a team of skilled professionals in the departments of General Medicine, Paediatrics, General Surgery, Obstetrics & Gynaecology, Anaesthesia, General Dentistry, and Community Health, we strive to offer comprehensive care for individuals of all ages and backgrounds. Our commitment extends beyond medical expertise, we prioritize affordability by ensuring that quality healthcare remains accessible to everyone. Patients are charged only the actual cost of care, without passing on the expenses related to equipment and infrastructure.



We train and equip young doctors willing to serve in rural India not only with medical knowledge but also with the compassion needed to serve with empathy and integrity.

Today, with the burden of older infectious diseases like Malaria and Tuberculosis still remaining, we are seeing the rapid rise of newer non-communicable diseases like Hypertension, Diabetes, Kidney Disease, Suicides and Sickle Cell Disorder and its related complications among people who are already poor and vulnerable.

In addition to our medical services, our hospital proudly hosts a **College of Nursing** offering programs in General Nursing and Midwifery (GNM) as well as Bachelor of Science in Nursing (B.Sc. Nursing). These programs are meticulously designed to provide rigorous training under the guidance of dedicated and skilled tutors, both in clinical settings and within the community. This approach ensures that our nurses develop a deep understanding of the context and challenges of our community and are well-equipped with the knowledge and skills needed to serve the region effectively. In doing so, we also contribute to elevating the overall standard of healthcare delivery in Odisha.



Expanding our commitment beyond healthcare, we take pride in operating the **New Life English Medium ICSE School**. Initially established to meet the educational needs of our staff's children, the school has since flourished, extending its reach to families in Bissamcuttack and the neighbouring towns. With an enrolment exceeding 550 students, our institution is dedicated to providing top-tier education, nurturing intellectual development, and preparing the next generation for a promising future.



The Community Health Department of CHB, operating under the acronym "**MITRA**," (**Madsen Institute for Tribal and Rural Advancement**) extends CHB's influence beyond campus boundaries by engaging with approximately 13,500 individuals residing in 54 tribal villages in the most remote parts of our community.

Through **MRSK**, (**Mitra Residential School at Kachapaju**) A 27 year old, recognised, residential, adivasi school offering education in Kuvi-cum-Odia Medium. MITRA strives to uplift these communities, fostering better health outcomes and educational opportunities amongst those otherwise unreachable. MRSK currently has 135 students in Std 1-5, served by 12 staff . The education Costs are provided through CHB.



CHB functions as a close-knit family, offering consistent support and encouragement to one another. The unity we have built is deeply valued, and it is my prayer that it continues to strengthen us in the days ahead.

To God be the glory.

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